



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 3

ARKANSAS

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Arkansas's family courts and child-welfare system.

32

ARKANSAS FAMILIES ON RECORD · 38
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS
MEDIAN TIME IN SYSTEM

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 20, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
10 OF 75

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

ARKANSAS AT A GLANCE.

Across 32 Arkansas families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 38 16 of 32 families reporting with kids	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$12,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 24 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 40.6% 28.1% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 32	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 2.4	REPORTING FAMILIES 16 of 32	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 10

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Arkansas families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF ARKANSAS FAMILY COURT

Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	20	\$12,000	\$83,575	\$1,671,500
Lost Wages	18	\$60,000	\$348,056	\$6,265,000
Other Court Fees	14	\$1,600	\$23,213	\$324,980
Therapy / Evaluations	16	\$2,500	\$11,856	\$189,700
Reunification Services	11	\$0	\$373	\$4,100
GAL Fees	15	\$750	\$22,363	\$335,450
Asset Loss ¹	17	\$50,000	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$126,850	—	—

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$50,000) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS

Median months lost		24	2 yrs
Mean months lost		30	2.5 yrs
Total across all families		630	52.5 yrs

03 WHO IS REPORTING · ARKANSAS

Most families documenting in Arkansas are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Currently involved / "S...		9	28%
Case closed (more tha...		5	16%
Case closed (within th...		4	12%
I am currently stuck in ...		4	12%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Both Family Court and ...		18	56%
Family Court Only		5	16%
CPS (Child Protective ...		4	12%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		15	47%
3 – 5 years		4	12%
5 – 10 years		4	12%
5+ years		3	9%
Over 10 years		2	6%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Los...		11	34%
Visitation Only		7	22%
Adopted Out (Rights T...		5	16%
Full Custody		3	9%
50/50 Joint		3	9%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

Washington		4	12%
Craighead		3	9%
Boone		2	6%
Lonoke		2	6%
Sebastian		2	6%
Pulaski		2	6%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Acc...		12	38%
Other: (Short answer)		9	28%
False Accusations CPS...		5	16%
Family Court		3	9%
High Conflict Divorce		1	3%

05 PARENT VOICES — ARKANSAS

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



Family court is a fraud. Judges are bias, violated my teen and my rights, and failed to protect him to further abuse.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Dhs-dcfs, child litem, casa fosters family court judge and attorneys

— ANTONIA

#AmericaFamilyCourtTraffickingGenocideMatters!
#ArkansasTraffickingVeteransChildren!
#USATraffickingUSACHildren!
#AmericanChildrenNotForSale!

— AUBREY

Bankrupted us we lost our home, boats, vehicles sanity and caused grievance fir lost time with our grand children

— BRENDA

Severe mental trauma PTSD depression

— KEVIN

My children were removed from my care by the Arkansas Division of Family Services under circumstances that were both unfair and deeply distressing. For over a year, the agency made it nearly impossible for me to regain custody, despite my constant efforts to comply with every [...]

— CHARISSA

Instead of protecting our family and those at risk, DCFS and the juvenile justice system has fractured our family. The trauma experienced doesn't just impact us but it will impact my nieces and their children and their children's children.

— TAMARA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



American Family Court Genocide Has Killed My Family. American Veterans Children Matter!!

— AUBREY

Ripped us apart, erased the God given fact that I gave birth to my son, utterly and completely destroyed the relationship between my only child and I. Made me out to be so.e ki d of criminal, crazy drug addict who was incapable of caring for her son.

— ANGELA

Tear it apart, destroy my childrens upbringing, allowed them to learn that lying gets you what you want and theres no consequences.

— AMANDA

Him and the court has caused confusion with my children. Being alienated because your ex is beyond disgruntled and obsessed with destroying myself and my kids self esteem, security, and bond with their mother.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Lied under oath, broke my son's arm under care and still was able to adopt him, sent cruel messages and told me to sign my rights away

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

They have failed my son in every way possible including protecting him they removed based on false allegations and my other children miss their brother we want him located his safety verified and home where he is loved wanted missed and safe! I have everything ready and I'm so [...]

— AMY

I have four children in which one of my children is autistic level three nonverbal. He has not seen me in five months. I have not slept a good night sleep in over six months. I sleep for maybe two hours and I'm up for 22.

— BRITTANY

American Family Court Genocide Matters. Arkansas Hates Family And Has Destroyed Mine And Tried To Kill Us. I am a combat veteran..this family Court war....is worse than war in the Middle East.

— AUBREY

I dropped my kids off at school and they never got off the bus. I was met outside my home with handcuffs to be taken to interrogation room. My youngest had no mental health problems and now she deals with severe separation anxiety from me. My oldest struggles to fight the [...]

— JENESSA

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



I've been being sued my Dad/Stepmom since 2018-2026 for full custody of my two daughters he got temporary custody of them and has had that now for 13 months

— CHRISTINE

The court ignored my daughter's statements of sexual abuse and awarded custody to her abuser. She has since experienced SI. The court refused to acknowledge violations of court order.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Disregarded the laws and opened my eyes to realize the laws are seemingly made for civilians and not for government officials to follow. OR Do as I say, not as I do. They are judge and jury in a no jury, unlawful, overpowered bias system.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

I have lost everything.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system has torn my family apart my son's father has passed since this beginning of this and he didn't even get to grieve during this difficult time of losing his dad which was his world

— STACEY

It didn't listen to me when I said he'll move far away and then take the girls. That he'll just keep coming at me until they are 18 when he can't make money off of them

— JESSICA

22 Arkansas parents submitted ranked quotes. 22 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/ar.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Arkansas report comes from Arkansas respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Arkansas — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 32 Arkansas families reporting here are not the universe of Arkansas families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics (email + name + submission date) are applied before aggregation. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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